PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Security | Cloud Security | Vulnerability Management

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience securing enterprise environments across Microsoft 365 (M365), Azure, and Amazon Web Services (AWS). I specialise in deploying and tuning Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Intune, and Microsoft Entra ID to protect large-scale workforces. At the University of the Arts London (UAL) I led the deployment of Microsoft Defender across an 8,000-user estate and built automated detection and response workflows using Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR), and Microsoft Sentinel. I bring strong expertise in enterprise vulnerability management using Tenable.io, Nessus, and CrowdStrike Falcon, combined with a pragmatic approach to risk reduction across endpoints, cloud infrastructure, and applications. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and thrive in environments that value security engineering depth alongside clear communication and collaborative problem solving.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Endpoint Security:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender XDR, CrowdStrike Falcon (Endpoint Detection and Response, Next-Generation SIEM, Insight, Discover, Prevent)
- **Identity and Access:** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure security controls (Defender for Cloud, Key Vault, Private Link), AWS security, Microsoft 365 (M365) security configuration and hardening
- **Endpoint Management:** Microsoft Intune, Mobile Device Management (MDM), Mobile Application Management (MAM), Tanium, Group Policy
- **SIEM and Detection:** Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Splunk/SPL, detection rule development and tuning
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Qualys (familiarity), Defender Vulnerability Management
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK framework, threat hunting, forensic investigation, security alert triage
- **Security Automation:** PowerShell scripting, SOAR playbook development, Microsoft Sentinel automation rules and playbooks
- **Frameworks and Compliance:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO/IEC 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Other Tools:** Mimecast, Check Point Harmony firewall, Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Lead the engineering and operational management of Microsoft Defender XDR, Defender for Endpoint, Microsoft Intune, and Entra ID across an 8,000-user hybrid enterprise environment spanning on-premises and Microsoft Azure and M365 cloud services.
- Architect and maintain endpoint protection and compliance policies in Intune, integrating with Conditional Access to enforce zero-trust access controls and reduce the attack surface across Windows, macOS, iOS, and Android devices.
- Design, build, and tune detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL analytics to identify threat actor behaviour aligned with the MITRE ATT&CK framework, reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Lead enterprise vulnerability management using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS to continuously assess endpoints, cloud workloads, and applications, prioritising remediation by risk severity and business impact.

- Develop and maintain SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to accelerate alert triage, incident containment, and reporting, reducing manual analyst effort.
- Oversee CrowdStrike Falcon deployment for endpoint detection and response, performing threat hunting across the estate using Falcon Insight and NG-SIEM telemetry.
- Manage identity security using Entra ID, including Privileged Identity Management (PIM), Conditional Access policy design, MFA rollout, and SSO integration across SaaS and on-premises applications.
- Collaborate with IT, infrastructure, and application teams to embed security controls into cloud migration projects, AWS workload deployments, and M365 configuration changes.
- Produce executive-level security reporting and metrics, communicating risk posture, vulnerability trends, and incident outcomes to senior leadership and governance committees.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 – March 2025*

- Monitored and triaged security alerts across Microsoft Sentinel, Defender XDR, and CrowdStrike Falcon, investigating incidents in accordance with NIST SP 800-61 incident response procedures.
- Supported the deployment and configuration of Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Defender for Office 365 to detect lateral movement, phishing, and email-based threats.
- Contributed to enterprise vulnerability management using Tenable.io, Nessus, and AppCheck, tracking remediation progress against agreed service level agreements.
- Administered BeyondTrust PAM solutions to control and monitor privileged access to critical systems, enforcing least-privilege principles.
- Maintained Mimecast email security gateway configuration, investigating email-borne threats and improving spam, phishing, and malware detection policies.
- Assisted in Cyber Essentials Plus certification processes, performing internal assessments and aligning controls with the CIS Controls and ISO/IEC 27001 frameworks.
- Authored and maintained incident response playbooks, security runbooks, and procedure documentation to support consistent analyst response across the security operations function.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) — IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 – March 2022*

- Managed endpoint security and infrastructure hardening for a Software as a Service (SaaS) FinTech company, ensuring compliance with ISO/IEC 27001 and CIS Benchmarks.
- Configured and maintained cloud-based security controls across Microsoft Azure and M365 tenants, including Conditional Access, Entra ID identity governance, and Intune endpoint policies.
- Performed vulnerability assessments and patch management, coordinating remediation with infrastructure and development teams to reduce exposure in production environments.
- Supported implementation of SSO and MFA across the company's SaaS platform integrations, improving identity security posture for internal and customer-facing services.
- Responded to security incidents and conducted root cause analysis, documenting findings and driving improvements to detection and prevention controls.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed and operationalised Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Defender XDR across 8,000 users at UAL, achieving full endpoint telemetry coverage and centralised threat visibility within the Microsoft M365 security ecosystem.
- Built a library of KQL-based detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel mapped to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques, reducing false-positive alert volumes and improving analyst response accuracy.
- Led enterprise vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS, reducing critical vulnerability exposure by prioritising remediation across cloud, endpoint, and application tiers.
- Automated security alert triage and incident enrichment workflows using SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, cutting average investigation time for common alert types.
- Maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification for UAL, coordinating cross-team efforts to meet technical control requirements across endpoints, firewalls, patch management, and access controls.
- Designed and enforced Conditional Access and Intune compliance policies to extend zero-trust principles across BYOD and corporate-managed mobile devices.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (United Kingdom)